

Nautilus Biotechnology

NASDAQ : NAUT · Young-Company DCF (Damodaran)

\$2.40

\$302M mkt cap · 126M sh · \$143M cash, zero debt

THE CENTRAL QUESTION

Will Nautilus capture meaningful share of a \$130B global proteomics TAM by 2036 with its Voyager single-molecule platform — or is today's \$302M market cap pricing certainty about commercial economics that the late-2026 launch and early-2027 instrument installations haven't yet earned?

NAUT trades at \$2.40 (\$302M mkt cap, 47% in cash) on essentially zero revenue. The Voyager single-molecule platform: Tau Early Access since Jan 2026; commercial launch late 2026, first instrument installs early 2027, Broadscale (10B-protein mapping) H1 2027. Cash to ~mid-2029; dilutive raise likely 2027-2028. Mature peers — Olink (Thermo), SomaScan (SBT), Quantum-Si, mass spec — anchor terminal margins and TAM. Young-company DCF: TAM × margin × P(fail). Four scenarios, weighted; show your work.

PROBABILITY-WEIGHTED EXPECTED VALUE

\$5.69
expected fair value today
+136.9% vs spot \$2.40

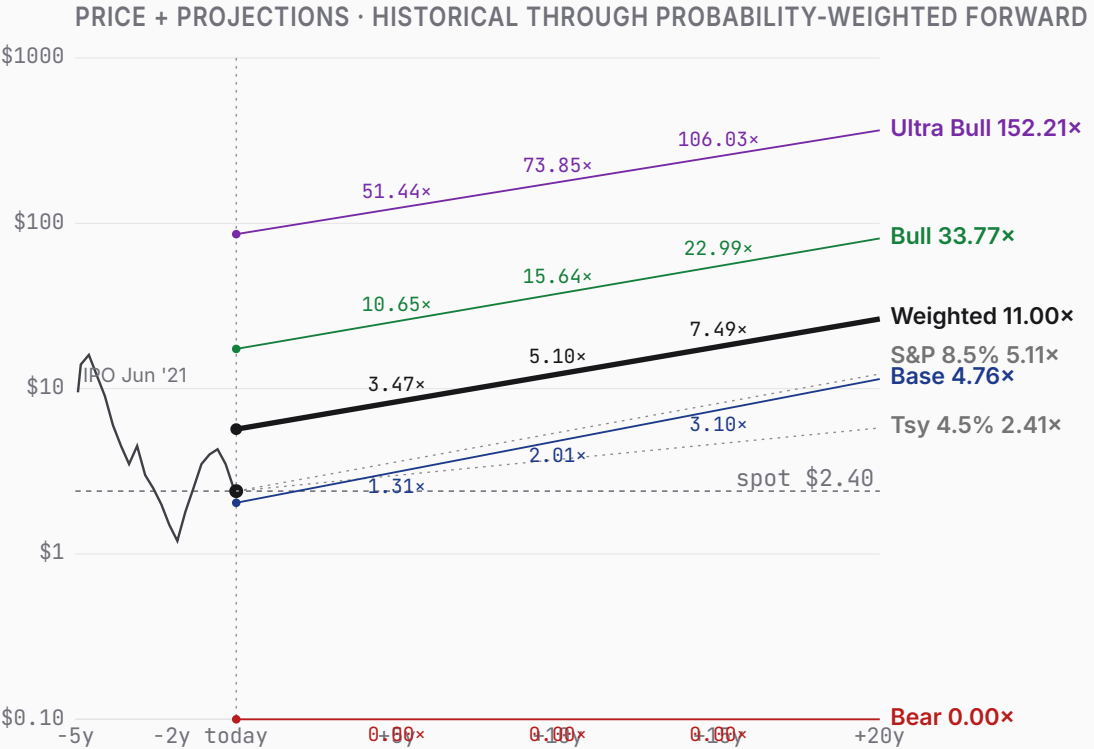
FORWARD COMPOUNDED VALUE

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
\$8.34	\$12.24	\$17.97	\$26.40
3.47× spot	5.10× spot	7.49× spot	11.00× spot

WEIGHTING RATIONALE

- Bear 35%** Single-molecule unproven at scale; entrenched affinity competition (Olink, SomaScan).
Base 50% Modal: Voyager launches on schedule, ~1-2% FY36 TAM share, niche-but-real proteomics platform.
Bull 12% Compound conditional: single-molecule wins proteoform race; Tau success catalyzes mainstream adoption.
Ultra Bull 3% Tail of tails: dominant proteomics + multiomics + software-take-rate + platform re-rating.

Bull (12%) + Ultra Bull (3%) together contribute \$4.67 — 82% of the \$5.69 expected value despite 15% combined probability. Today's spot (\$2.40) sits 58% below the weighted expected; forward-weighted value crosses spot between +5y and +10y.



BEAR	\$0.00	BASE	\$2.04	BULL	\$17.39	ULTRA BULL	\$86.00
	-100.0% vs spot		-15.0% vs spot		+624.6% vs spot		+3483.3% vs spot
TAM 0.5% P(fail) 40% S2C 0.7 Prob 35%		TAM 1.2% P(fail) 18% S2C 1.0 Prob 50%		TAM 1.5% P(fail) 8% S2C 1.4 Prob 12%		TAM 3.1% P(fail) 3% S2C 1.6 Prob 3%	
Capital exhausts; equity wiped.		Niche-but-real proteomics player.		Single-molecule wins proteoforms.		Dominant + multiomics + take-rate.	



Nautilus Biotechnology scenario narratives

PROBABILITY WEIGHTS

Bear 35% Base 50% Bull 12% Ultra Bull 3% · Weighted expected \$5.69 (+136.9% vs spot)

BEAR	\$0.00	BASE	\$2.04	BULL	\$17.39	ULTRA BULL	\$86.00
	-100.0% vs spot		-15.0% vs spot		+624.6% vs spot		+3483.3% vs spot

Probability 35%

Capital exhausts; equity wiped.

WHY 35%

Pre-revenue single-molecule platforms face a stack of risks the public market knows well — IPO'd peers show the path is hard (Olink acquired by Thermo at a premium; SomaLogic merged into Standard BioTools at a discount; Quantum-Si still pre-revenue). NAUT-specific: Voyager's late-2026 launch already slipped; the Jan 2026 Early Access Program is real but narrow (Tau proteoforms first); \$143M cash extends to mid-2029 but commercial scale-up requires a 2027–2028 dilutive raise. Bear case is structural — tech doesn't scale beyond niche, or proteoform analysis stays a research curiosity rather than a clinical workhorse. 35% weight (vs JOBY's 30%): NAUT is one stage earlier, with a smaller cash buffer and more direct competition. Within-scenario 40% p_fail captures Nautilus-specific bankruptcy risk.

WHAT HAPPENS

The pessimistic case is structural. Voyager's single-molecule resolution doesn't deliver at commercial scale: Tau Early Access data through 2026-27 surfaces reproducibility or throughput limitations that cap broader adoption. Broadscale (H1 2027) slips or underwhelms. Customers default to affinity platforms (Olink at Thermo, SomaScan at SBT) for routine proteomics and to mass spec for high-end research, leaving single-molecule proteomics as a research-niche curiosity.

To maintain solvency through commercial launch, NAUT raises ~\$1.1B cumulatively at \$0.40-2.00/share — successive dilutive rounds at falling prices as the equity story deteriorates. Share count balloons from 126M to ~1.78B (93% dilution). By FY36 NAUT reaches just 0.5% of the \$130B proteomics TAM — \$600M revenue at 8% margin, profitable but tiny relative to the diluted share count.

Probability 50%

Niche-but-real proteomics player.

WHY 50%

Modal outcome. Voyager launches on or near schedule (late 2026 pre-orders, early 2027 installations); proteoform assay portfolio expands to 5-10 assays by 2030; installed base reaches 500-1000 instruments by 2030. NAUT reaches ~1-2% share of the \$130B FY36 proteomics TAM — meaningful but not dominant. Mature operating margin ~15-18% — between commodity tools (~10%) and high-margin specialty diagnostics (~25%). Dilution from ~\$1.08B of 2027-2029 raises at \$3-14/share lands at ~57% total. The 50% weight reflects that this is the modal outcome — most realistic for a strong technical team executing on a long timeline, but not requiring breakthrough commercial dominance against entrenched affinity-platform competitors (Olink/Thermo, SomaScan/SBT). Base case is well-executed but stays a niche player; multiple stays compressed.

WHAT HAPPENS

The middle path. Voyager launches on or near the late-2026 schedule; pre-orders convert to \$5-15M of revenue in 2027 from early adopters (academic + select biopharma). The Tau proteoforms assay drives Alzheimer's research adoption — a credible biomarker hook into a large neuroscience research market. A second proteoform assay extends utility. Broadscale (H1 2027) opens the addressable market beyond niche use cases without yet displacing affinity platforms for routine work.

Through 2028-2030, the installed base grows from ~100 instruments to ~500. Average revenue per instrument settles at \$250-400K/yr (instrument + consumables + assay subscriptions). NAUT raises ~\$1.08B cumulatively at \$3-14/share to fund commercial scale-up, lifting share count to ~293M (57% dilution). Operating margin crosses zero by 2030 and scales toward 16% by 2036 — between commodity tools and specialty diagnostics.

Probability 12%

Single-molecule wins proteoforms.

WHY 12%

Compound conditional: Voyager establishes single-molecule resolution as the new gold standard for proteoform analysis (40-50% conditional on execution) AND Tau success drives Alzheimer's research/biomarker mainstream adoption (50%) AND assay portfolio expands to 10-15+ proteoforms by 2030 (60% conditional) AND mature margins reach 20-25% (40% conditional) AND the market gives NAUT credit via acquisition or re-rating (50%). Joint at 10-15%, reflected at 12%. The bull requires conjunctive execution AND a favorable backdrop where affinity platforms (Olink at Thermo, SomaScan at SBT) don't simply absorb the single-molecule frontier. 12% (vs JOBY's 12%): structurally similar compound venture-bet, but a clearer near-term path (launch ~6 months out vs JOBY's still-pending Type Certification).

WHAT HAPPENS

The bull case is that single-molecule resolution becomes the new gold standard for proteoform analysis. Tau success — FDA biomarker validation, mainstream adoption in Alzheimer's drug development — catalyzes broader category acceptance. Broadscale (H1 2027) delivers on the 10B-protein-mapping promise; customers adopt Voyager as the routine high-resolution workhorse alongside (not replacing) Olink and SomaScan.

By 2030, NAUT operates 2,000+ instruments globally at \$300-500K/yr each (instrument + reagents + assay subscriptions). Assay catalog expands from 2 to 15+ proteoform assays. Pharma partnerships drive multi-year recurring revenue. Operating margin reaches 22% by FY36 as software/assay mix shifts to higher-margin recurring revenue. NAUT becomes an obvious acquisition target for Thermo / Danaher / Bruker at premium multiples — or remains independent at platform-tools scale.

Probability 3%

Dominant + multiomics + take-rate.

WHY 3%

Tail of tails: requires every Bull condition to hit AND multiomics integration becomes routine (proteomics + sequencing + cell biology fused as the new research and diagnostic standard) AND NAUT captures dominant share at 3%+ of \$130B TAM AND software-economics emerge via instrument-as-a-service / assay-take-rate model AND multiple re-rates from tools to platform. Each individually 30-50% conditional on the prior; joint at 2-4%. Captures the scenario where NAUT joins the platform-tools tier (Thermo / Danaher / Illumina) rather than remaining a niche tools player. 3% weight matches JOBY's ultra-bull pattern (genuine tail-of-tails reflecting compound conditional + market re-rating).

WHAT HAPPENS

The ultra-bull case requires Voyager to become the dominant single-molecule proteomics platform AND for multiomics integration (proteomics + sequencing + cell biology) to emerge as the standard for both research and diagnostics. By 2030 NAUT operates 5,000+ instruments globally. By 2034, an instrument-as-a-service / assay-take-rate model emerges with software-economics on a meaningful fraction of revenue — the Mobileye/Illumina platform-take-rate analog.

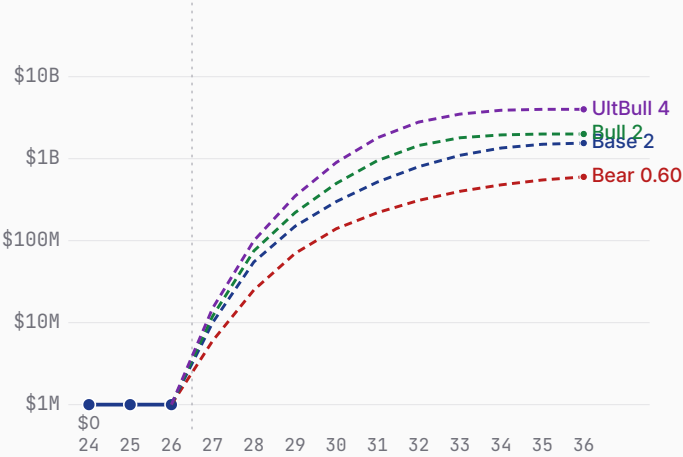
Compound conditional: Voyager wins the single-molecule race (30% conditional on Tau success) AND multiomics becomes routine (40% conditional on platform success) AND NAUT captures dominant share at 3%+ of \$130B TAM (25% conditional on both) AND multiple expansion from tools to platform (50% conditional on all above). Joint at 1.5-3%. Reflected here at 3%.

Nautilus Biotechnology business snapshot

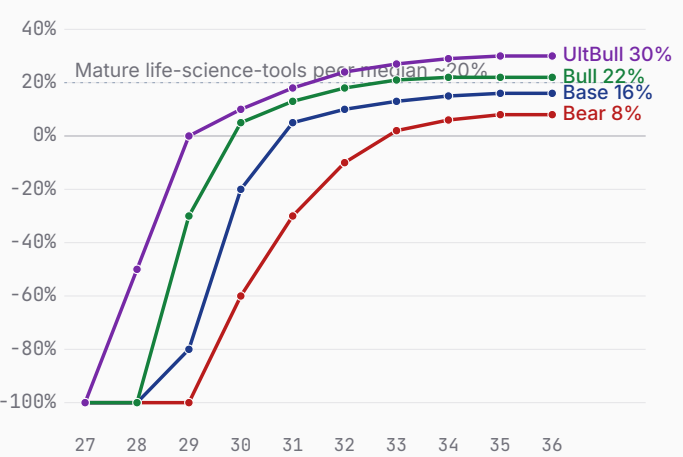
Bear \$0.00 Base \$2.04 Bull \$17.39

FY24-FY26 history + FY27-FY36 scenario projections · fiscal years end Dec 31 · Q1 2026 10-Q, Voyager press releases, peer market cap data

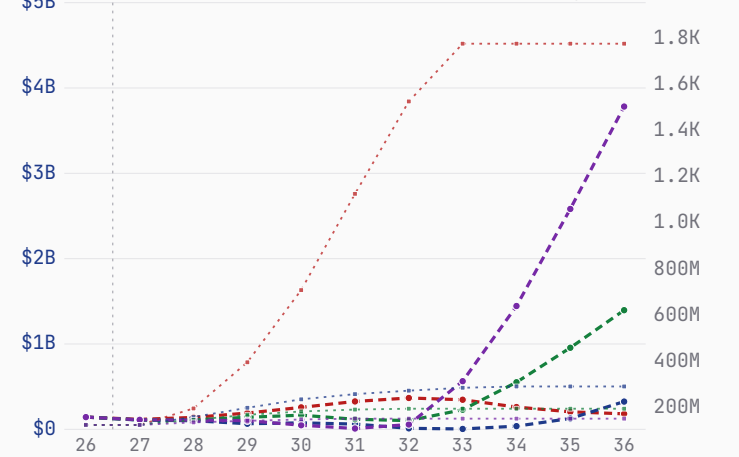
Revenue — history + scenarios to FY36 (log)



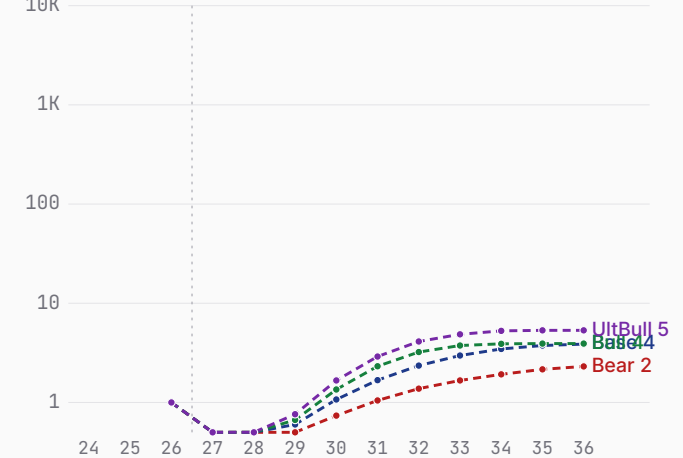
Path to profitability — op margin (FY27→FY36)



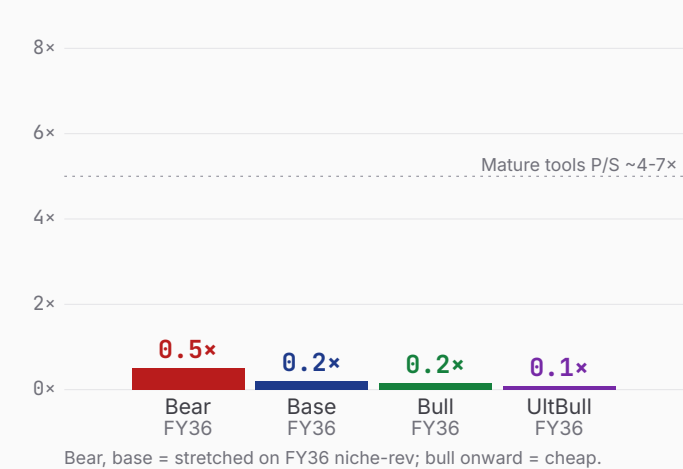
Cash + dilution (FY26 → FY36)



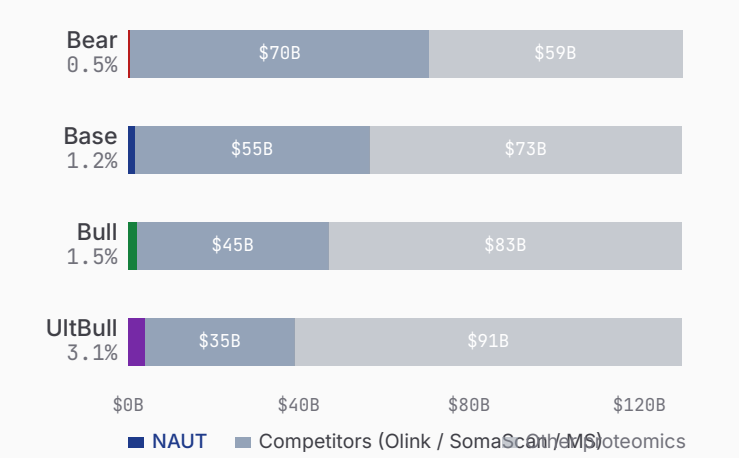
Voyager instruments deployed (log)



\$0.30B mkt cap as P/S on FY36 rev



\$130B global proteomics TAM (FY36) — NAUT share



Sources: NAUT 10-K FY25, Q1 2026 10-Q, Voyager Early Access Program press releases (Jan 2026), MarketsandMarkets proteomics market sizing 2030-2035, peer transaction data (Olink/Thermo, SomaLogic/SBT).

Nautilus Biotechnology 7 Powers · the moat, scored

Bear \$0.00 Base \$2.04 Bull \$17.39

Arena. Broad-scale proteomics — Nautilus's single-molecule protein-analysis platform vs Seer, Olink/Thermo, SomaLogic/Standard BioTools, Quantum-Si; the race to high-throughput, deep proteome coverage.

POWER ORIENTATION
origination window: closing

POWER ORIENTATION · 7 POWERS

Scale Economies	Pre-revenue; no instruments placed, no consumable pull-through yet.
Network Economies	No installed base or data ecosystem yet.
Counter-Positioning	Multi-affinity-probe single-molecule decoding — distinct from mass-spec and aptamer incumbents.
Switching Costs	None until an instrument ships and labs standardize on it.
Branding	Scientific credibility; unproven commercially.
Cornered Resource · thesis leans here	Core IP on the probe-cycling decode method; well-funded cash position pre-launch.
Process Power	No manufacturing/assay learning curve yet.

THE RACE · NAMED RIVALS

Seer	public; cash-funded
~20% terminal share · Proteograph shipping with revenue; nanoparticle enrichment + MS.	
Olink (Thermo Fisher)	Thermo balance sheet
~25% terminal share · Established PEA panels (~5k proteins); NGS readout; Thermo distribution.	
SomaLogic / Standard BioTools	public; merged
~20% terminal share · Aptamer SomaScan (~11k); merged scale.	
Quantum-Si	public
~10% terminal share · Semiconductor protein sequencing; also early.	

LEAD / LAG · FALSIFIERS

Commercial instrument shipping	no (pre-launch) vs yes	LAGGING
Demonstrated proteome coverage	limited (dev) vs broad (~5-11k)	LAGGING
Cash runway (yrs at burn)	3 vs 3	EVEN

COMPETITIVE READ

Nautilus is originating a genuinely differentiated single-molecule platform with strong IP and a funded balance sheet, but it is pre-commercial and lags shipping rivals on every demonstrated metric; the window is open only while the cash lasts and before incumbents close the coverage gap — a launched, validated instrument is the falsifier.

Nautilus Biotechnology show your work

Bear \$0.00 Base \$2.04 Bull \$17.39 · Weighted \$5.69 (+136.9%)

BEAR\$0.00					BASE\$2.04					BULL\$17.39					ULTRA BULL\$86.00				
ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS				
TAM Year-10 (\$B)				130	TAM Year-10 (\$B)				130	TAM Year-10 (\$B)				130	TAM Year-10 (\$B)				130
Mature share (%)				0.5	Mature share (%)				1.2	Mature share (%)				1.5	Mature share (%)				3.1
Mature op margin (%)				8	Mature op margin (%)				16	Mature op margin (%)				22	Mature op margin (%)				30
Sales-to-capital				0.7	Sales-to-capital				1.0	Sales-to-capital				1.4	Sales-to-capital				1.6
Terminal WACC (%)				11.0	Terminal WACC (%)				9.0	Terminal WACC (%)				8.0	Terminal WACC (%)				7.5
Terminal growth (%)				2.0	Terminal growth (%)				2.5	Terminal growth (%)				3.0	Terminal growth (%)				3.5
P(failure) (%)				40	P(failure) (%)				18	P(failure) (%)				8	P(failure) (%)				3
Scenario probability (%)				35	Scenario probability (%)				50	Scenario probability (%)				12	Scenario probability (%)				3
10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B					10-YEAR DCF · \$B				
FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY27	0.01	-300%	-0.03	-0.02	FY27	0.01	-250%	-0.03	-0.03	FY27	0.01	-200%	-0.03	-0.03	FY27	0.01	-150%	-0.03	-0.03
FY28	0.03	-200%	-0.08	-0.06	FY28	0.06	-150%	-0.13	-0.10	FY28	0.07	-100%	-0.12	-0.10	FY28	0.10	-50%	-0.10	-0.08
FY29	0.07	-120%	-0.15	-0.10	FY29	0.15	-80%	-0.21	-0.15	FY29	0.22	-30%	-0.17	-0.12	FY29	0.35	+0%	-0.16	-0.11
FY30	0.14	-60%	-0.18	-0.11	FY30	0.30	-20%	-0.21	-0.13	FY30	0.50	+5%	-0.17	-0.11	FY30	0.90	+10%	-0.25	-0.17
FY31	0.22	-30%	-0.18	-0.10	FY31	0.52	+5%	-0.19	-0.11	FY31	0.95	+13%	-0.20	-0.12	FY31	1.80	+18%	-0.24	-0.14
FY32	0.31	-10%	-0.16	-0.08	FY32	0.80	+10%	-0.20	-0.10	FY32	1.45	+18%	-0.10	-0.05	FY32	2.80	+24%	+0.05	+0.03
FY33	0.40	+2%	-0.12	-0.05	FY33	1.10	+13%	-0.16	-0.07	FY33	1.80	+21%	+0.13	+0.06	FY33	3.50	+27%	+0.51	+0.26
FY34	0.48	+6%	-0.09	-0.03	FY34	1.35	+15%	-0.05	-0.02	FY34	1.95	+22%	+0.32	+0.15	FY34	3.90	+29%	+0.88	+0.40
FY35	0.55	+8%	-0.06	-0.02	FY35	1.50	+16%	+0.09	+0.03	FY35	2.00	+22%	+0.40	+0.17	FY35	4.00	+30%	+1.14	+0.48
FY36	0.60	+8%	-0.02	-0.01	FY36	1.55	+16%	+0.20	+0.07	FY36	2.00	+22%	+0.44	+0.17	FY36	4.00	+30%	+1.20	+0.47
Σ PV explicit FCF				-0.58	Σ PV explicit FCF				-0.61	Σ PV explicit FCF				+0.02	Σ PV explicit FCF				+1.11
+ PV terminal (g 2.0%)				0.00	+ PV terminal (g 2.5%)				1.18	+ PV terminal (g 3.0%)				3.52	+ PV terminal (g 3.5%)				12.30
EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE				
Operating EV				\$-0.58B	Operating EV				\$0.57B	Operating EV				\$3.54B	Operating EV				\$13.41B
+ Cash & investments				\$0.14B	+ Cash & investments				\$0.14B	+ Cash & investments				\$0.14B	+ Cash & investments				\$0.14B
= Equity value				\$-0.44B	= Equity value				\$0.71B	= Equity value				\$3.68B	= Equity value				\$13.55B
Raised over period				\$1.10B	Raised over period				\$1.08B	Raised over period				\$0.75B	Raised over period				\$0.65B
Dilution by FY36				+93%	Dilution by FY36				+57%	Dilution by FY36				+36%	Dilution by FY36				+18%
FY36 shares (M)				1,777	FY36 shares (M)				293	FY36 shares (M)				196	FY36 shares (M)				153
DCF per share				\$-0.25	DCF per share				\$2.42	DCF per share				\$18.78	DCF per share				\$88.56
× (1-P_fail) [60%]				\$-0.15	× (1-P_fail) [82%]				\$1.98	× (1-P_fail) [92%]				\$17.28	× (1-P_fail) [97%]				\$85.90
+ P_fail × distress [40% × \$0.15]				\$0.06	+ P_fail × distress [18% × \$0.30]				\$0.05	+ P_fail × distress [8% × \$1.50]				\$0.12	+ P_fail × distress [3% × \$3.00]				\$0.09
= Expected per share				\$0.00	= Expected per share				\$2.04	= Expected per share				\$17.39	= Expected per share				\$86.00
FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT				
+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y	
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00		\$3.14	\$4.83	\$7.43	\$11.43		\$25.55	\$37.54	\$55.16	\$81.05		\$123.46	\$177.25	\$254.46	\$365.32	
0.00×	0.00×	0.00×	0.00×		1.31×	2.01×	3.10×	4.76×		10.65×	15.64×	22.99×	33.77×		51.44×	73.85×	106.03×	152.21×	

Nautilus Biotechnology

supporting analysis · disclaimers · glossary

Bear \$0.00 Base \$2.04 Bull \$17.39

PUSHBACK · WHY THE BASE CASE IS TOO HARSH

- 1

Best-funded single-molecule platform.
\$143M cash, zero debt, cost discipline (16% headcount cut, Q1 burn \$12.8M). Runway to mid-2029. Peers are less funded relative to need.
- 2

Early Access is real, not vaporware.
Tau proteoforms EAP live since Jan 2026 with academic + biopharma partners. Post-tech-risk (instrument works), pre-commercial-scale.
- 3

First-mover in proteoform single-molecule.
Quantum-Si is sequencing-focused; affinity platforms (Olink/SomaScan) target a different modality. NAUT leads time-to-market in proteoforms.
- 4

Tau strategic positioning.
Alzheimer's biomarker market \$10B+; proteoform analysis is what makes Tau actionable. Single-product launch anchors adoption in a large research market.
- 5

Cash floor is real downside protection.
\$1.13/share cash vs \$2.40 spot = 47% of mkt cap is liquid. Operating EV ~\$1.27/share for a real platform. Hard to lose money permanently here.

FALSIFICATION TRIGGERS

Bear validation

Voyager pre-orders < \$10M by Q1 2027 · Cash < \$80M EOY 2027 · Broadscale slips to 2028+ · Tau EAP count flat YoY

Bull validation

Pre-orders > \$30M by Q1 2027 · 100+ instruments installed EOY 2027 · second pharma/OEM partnership · multi-year take-rate deal disclosed

Reframe needed

If Quantum-Si or a new entrant hits single-molecule resolution at lower cost/higher throughput first — NAUT's first-mover edge erodes; share-of-TAM compresses

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Scenarios, valuations, projections, and any forward-looking statements involve substantial assumptions and uncertainty. Actual results may differ materially from those projected. Past performance is not indicative of future results. The model is a model; reality is not.

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GLOSSARY · CONCEPTS REFERENCED IN THE NARRATIVE

Voyager — NAUT's single-molecule proteomics platform — instrument + reagents + assays + software for proteoform analysis.

Proteoforms — Protein variants from a single gene (post-translational modifications, splice variants). Single-molecule readout resolves these vs ensemble methods.

Tau — Microtubule-associated protein; key Alzheimer's biomarker. Tau proteoform analysis is NAUT's first commercial assay, live in Early Access since Jan 2026.

Early Access Program — Limited release to academic + biopharma partners ahead of general availability. Live since Jan 2026 (Tau assay); expands to Broadscale H1 2027.

Broadscale — Voyager's planned 10-billion-protein-mapping capability for general proteomics, scheduled for H1 2027 general availability.

S2C (sales-to-capital) — Damodaran reinvestment ratio. $\Delta\text{Revenue} / \text{S2C}$ = reinvestment in \$. NAUT case ranges 0.7-1.7 (capital-light hardware-software blend).